JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Engineer with 6 years of hands-on experience building and maintaining scalable data pipelines across cloud platforms. I've spent the last three years at a fintech startup where I designed infrastructure that processes millions of transactions daily. I'm based in Edinburgh and currently focused on optimizing data workflows while mentoring junior engineers. I prefer practical solutions over theoretical approaches and have a strong track record of reducing query times and storage costs.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer

Fintech Solutions Ltd

www.fintechsolutions.io

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a real-time data pipeline processing 5 million events per day using Apache Kafka and Spark, reducing latency from 45 minutes to under 2 minutes for financial transaction analytics.

Led the migration of legacy batch jobs from on-premise Hadoop clusters to AWS EMR and S3, saving the company 40 percent in infrastructure costs while improving processing speed by 3 times.

Mentored 2 junior data engineers on best practices for Python and SQL, establishing code review standards that reduced production incidents related to data quality by 65 percent.

Developed and maintained comprehensive data quality monitoring dashboards using Tableau, flagging schema changes and anomalies that would have impacted 12 downstream analytics teams.

Data Engineer

Insights Analytics Group

www.insightsanalytics.co

Glasgow, United Kingdom

June 2020 - February 2022

Built ETL pipelines using Python and Apache Airflow to ingest data from 30 different third-party APIs, automating manual processes that previously required 20 hours per week of manual effort.

Optimized Redshift queries by rewriting complex SQL and implementing appropriate distribution keys, cutting average query time from 8 minutes to 45 seconds for executive dashboards.

Designed and documented a data warehouse schema supporting customer behavior analysis for the marketing team, enabling them to segment audiences without requiring engineering support.

Collaborated with data scientists to create feature engineering pipelines that improved machine learning model accuracy by 18 percent through better data preparation and validation.

Junior Data Engineer

DataFlow Systems

www.dataflowsystems.net

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

July 2018 - May 2020

Developed Python scripts to automate daily data extraction from multiple databases, reducing manual data preparation tasks and improving data freshness from weekly to daily updates.

Maintained and troubleshot existing SQL queries and stored procedures supporting business intelligence reports, achieving 99.2 percent uptime for critical overnight batch jobs.

Created comprehensive documentation and runbooks for data pipeline processes, enabling the operations team to independently monitor and troubleshoot common issues.

Assisted in the implementation of a data governance framework including metadata cataloging and data lineage tracking across 50 different data sources.

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

2016 - 2018

BSc Computer Science

University of Glasgow

Glasgow, United Kingdom

2012 - 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Scala, Bash

Big Data Technologies: Apache Spark, Apache Hadoop, Apache Airflow, Apache Kafka

Cloud Platforms: Amazon Web Services (S3, EMR, Redshift, RDS), Google Cloud Platform (BigQuery, Dataflow)

Data Warehousing: Redshift, Snowflake, PostgreSQL

Data Quality and Monitoring: Great Expectations, Datadog, Custom monitoring solutions

Tools and Frameworks: Git, Docker, Jenkins, Tableau, DBT

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB

Version Control: Git, GitHub Enterprise